Gudjon "Johnny" Johannesson Kristjan "Kris" Johannesson

June 5, 1922 - December 18, 1994 December 22, 1925 - April 19, 2010

In the early 1930's in Riverton, Manitoba, a truly legendary journey began with Sturlaugur "Laugi" Johannesson Sr. and his two young sons, Johnny, aged 12 and Kris, aged 9 playing violin for various house parties.

By 1941, Johnny and Kris had now become seasoned performers. Between 1941-1950 they gradually encouraged the remaining siblings Dorothy, Sella, Laugi and Kristine, along with family friend Harold Bjornson to join them in a full band. This was the start of "Johnny and His Musical Mates."

The band became a legendary name in Manitoba's Interlake Region, and an integral part of Riverton Music History spanning over six decades. They were sought after for their old-time danceable feel with a rich, full bodied musical sound. Johnny's strong lead violin along with Kris's smooth harmony were so in sync that often it sounded like just one amazing violin playing.

"This Incredible Family of Musicians will be remembered not only for their amazing fiddle music, but the hope they created in people's lives"

For their dedication to playing, Manitoba Fiddle Association recognizes Johnny and His Musical Mates as outstanding Performers!

2024